

Conclusion

Today, the Eastern Learning (Donghak) Peasant Movement is being re-evaluated as a modern movement comparable to the French Revolution, and Daesoon (Daesun) Thought is attracting attention as an ideology that can explain the changes in the post-modern world through the traditional Eastern system of thought. This dissertation centers on the concept of "Donghak" (Eastern Learning) as a method of thought in Eastern philosophy and aims to demonstrate that the two systems of thought (Donghak and Daesoon) both built East Asia's indigenous (jasaengjeok) modernity through the reconstruction of the trinitarian cosmology of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind.

The series of discussions revealed in this dissertation can be summarized as follows. The alternative to Western modernity, which is in crisis, can be found in the alternative modernity demonstrated by the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought. The reason for this is that the cause of the crisis in Western modernity lies in Western immanence, which views the change of all things only through substance, whereas the East possesses correlative thinking, which explains the change of all things through attributes. Western postmodern theories, after long discussions, have come to explain Eastern rationality through correlative thinking and liminality. Accordingly, the new alternative views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind established by Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought can be explained by the liminality of correlative (sanggwanjeok) thinking.

Liminality, meaning threshold or boundary, reveals the chaotic dynamic characteristics of Eastern thought that pursues the harmony of Yin and Yang by encompassing both mutually opposing elements to harmonize their opposition for the sake of passage through the boundary in rites of passage—that is, for change. On the other hand, correlative thinking reveals the fractal static characteristics that all things are interconnected. Through the liminality of correlative thinking, which synthesizes these two characteristics, the Heaven, Earth, and Humankind of the East and West are interconnected. Heaven and Earth become an existence like Gun-Sa-Bu (Monarch, Teacher, and Father) to human beings. Just as in human relationships, where subjects, disciples, and children are beings who receive and realize the will of the Gun-Sa-Bu, human beings receive grace from Heaven and Earth, repay that grace, and become beings of Yeocheonjidong (Sharing the Same [Virtues] with Heaven and Earth), learning abilities equivalent to Heaven and Earth.

In Donghak Thought, when the Cheonsa-mundap (Q&A with the Heavenly Teacher) took place, the purpose of the Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) was to revitalize the liminality of correlative thinking in the Three Realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind. Accordingly, Donghak Thought presents new views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind based on the emergence of the Cheon-oe-cheon. The views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind newly presented by Donghak Thought consist of the view of Heaven as Sicheonju (Bearing the Heavenly Lord), the view of Earth as Jowha-jeong (Fixing the Creation), and the

view of Humankind as Yeongse-bulmang (Never forgetting for all ages). The Three Realms of Donghak Thought, in turn, interact based on a Gwisillon (theory of spirits) relationship between Heaven and Earth, through a Gihwaron (theory of materialization/spiritualization) Heaven-human relationship, and a Ji-in-gwangye (Earth-human relationship) of kings, nobles, generals, and ministers (Wanghu-jangsang). However, the Donghak view of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind failed to sufficiently overcome the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism and was discontinued.

In response, Daesoon Thought introduces the concepts of Sinmyeong (divine beings) and Wonhan (grievances) based on the incarnation of Gucheon (Sangje), and overcomes the Confucian limitations present in the Donghak view of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind with a Sin-in-uido (principle of mutual guidance between divine beings and human beings) view of the Three Realms. Daesoon Thought presents the view of the Heavenly Realm based on incarnation (Insin-gangse), the view of the Earthly Realm based on Cheonji-seonggyeongsin (Sincerity, Reverence, and Faith of Heaven and Earth), and the view of the Human Realm based on Seongsa-jaein (Accomplishment of affairs lies with human beings). The Three Realms of Daesoon Thought interact based on the principle of Yeocheonjidong (Sharing the Same [Virtues] with Heaven and Earth) and, grounded in the Heaven-Earth relationship of the Earthly Paradise (Jiseon-cheonguk), establish a Heaven-human relationship of Cheonji-boeun (Grateful Reciprocation to Heaven and Earth) and an Earth-human relationship of Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals), realizing this through the Cheonji-gongsa (Reordering Works of Heaven and Earth) and spiritual cultivation (Sudo).

Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought both commonly present indigenous modernity by achieving liminality through the revitalization of correlative thinking. If Donghak Thought focused on short-term liminality and contributed to the entry into revitalization, Daesoon Thought revitalized Donghak Thought where it had failed, presenting Cham Donghak (True Eastern Learning). Consequently, Donghak Thought possesses the properties of indigenous modernity characterized by Jakran (Creating Disorder) and the liminality of Potae (Embryonic stage), while Daesoon Thought manifests the revitalization of indigenous modernity characterized by Chiran (Remedying Disorder) and the liminality of Gwanwang (Peak stage).

The correlative thinking of Donghak Thought, revitalized by Daesoon Thought, appears more concretely in Daesoon Thought's reconstruction of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind. The correlative thinking of Daesoon Thought manifests as Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang), Samjae-hwakrip (Establishment of the Three Powers), and Ohaeng-gubi (Completion of the Five Elements). Unlike Donghak Thought, Daesoon Thought, in its view of the Heavenly Realm, establishes Mugeuk (Ultimate Nothingness) and Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate) through the Tae-eul-ju (Tae-eul Mantra), achieving the Eumyang-hapdeok of the Ibeopcheon (Heaven of Principle) and the Ingyeokcheon (Personal Heaven), and re-establishes the celestial order (Cheonmun). It also reconstructs the geography of the Earth by re-establishing the Samsinsan (Three Divine Mountains), the Bumosan (Parent Mountains), the Sanwang (Mountain King), and the Haewang (Sea King). This connects to human beings,

correcting the bloodlines and, through Haewon (Resolution of Grievances), aligning the Hwanggeuksin (Spirit of the August Pole) and the Myeongbu (Spirit Realm), among other aspects of the Spirit Realm (Sinmyeong-gye).

If the liminality and revitalization of religious anthropology are incomplete rites of passage that might end merely as rituals, the rite of passage in Daesoon Thought, which combines politics and edification, is a rite of passage connected to actual practice, continuing uninterrupted to this day and linking to the substance of Daesoon Jinrihoe. This harmonizes with the synchronicity of Daoism, the process philosophy of Buddhism, the correlative thinking of Confucianism, etc., forming an indigenous modernity where Eastern and Western modernities are harmonized.

The indigenous modernity manifested in the two thoughts can be summarized in detail as follows. To the public today, modernity means 'secularization,' but to researchers of 'modernity,' modernity was rather the 'rearrangement of the sacred (Seong) and the secular (Sok),' that is, the strengthening of divinity (Sinseong) through liminality. Even Western modernity, a representative example of 'secularization' today, began with Calvin's predestination and Descartes' *Cogito ergo sum* (I think, therefore I am). The reason 'modernity' was the greatest change among the countless changes in human history is that modernity was initially, like Calvin or Descartes, a permanent and enormous change of the 'sacred and secular' spanning material and spiritual realms—that is, a strengthening of divinity. However, modernity, contrary to its original purpose, transformed into secularization emphasizing only the 'secular' (Sok), reaching a crisis where divinity is disappearing from the earth.

Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought have long been widely discussed individually in academia as East Asia's indigenous modernity in comparison to postmodern philosophy. However, existing discussions of indigenous modernity have not emphasized their shared Eastern origins with Western modernity. Furthermore, the two thoughts have not been comparatively studied in terms of the form and principles of indigenous modernity manifested in the concept of "Donghak" (Eastern Learning). This dissertation, based on the concept of multiple modernities as the 'rearrangement of the sacred and the secular,' compares the indigenous modernity achieved by the two thoughts in their views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind using the Eastern philosophical method of correlative thinking, and aims to show the ideological value of the two thoughts more clearly.

Whether 'secularization' or the 'strengthening of divinity' through the 'rearrangement of the sacred and secular,' modernity manifests as political democratization, economic industrialization, and cultural diversification. In the case of Korea, which is almost unique among former colonized nations today in having achieved all three, there was an indigenous modernity not found in other countries. That is the Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) thought, represented by Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought. The Cheon-oe-cheon thought was a response to the problem posed by Matteo Ricci before the imperialist invasions. Matteo Ricci criticized that the East Asian views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind

had lost the personal divine characteristics of the Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) due to an overemphasis on Ibeophwa (rationalization) which only highlighted the attributive characteristics of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind. In response, Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought respectively presented an indigenous rearrangement of the sacred (Seong) and the secular (Sok) as an answer, integrating the Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind through the concepts of the emergence of the Cheon-oe-cheon and the incarnation (Tangang) of Gucheon (Sangje). The Gucheon (Sangje) of the two thoughts, being a Cheon-oe-cheon based on correlative thinking, was able to integrate the strengths of the Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind.

As a detailed methodology for comparing these two indigenous modernities, this dissertation used three methodologies: the theory of correlative thought by A.C. Graham and others, the theory of liminality by Victor Turner, and the theory of revitalization movement by Anthony Wallace. The reason for applying all three theories simultaneously is that they work organically together in comparative research. First, the theory of correlative thought clearly shows the epistemological differences between Eastern and Western ways of thinking, thereby clarifying the difference between indigenous modernity and (Western) modernity. Second, the theory of liminality is effective in explaining the process of rearrangement in modernity, which is the 'rearrangement of the sacred and the secular,' and third, the theory of revitalization is useful for explaining the succession of tradition manifested in the rearrangement process.

If the Western thought's views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind, which emphasize substance, are differentiating (Bunhwajeok), the Eastern thought's views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind, which emphasize attributes, exhibit assimilative (Donghwajeok), condensing (Eungchukjeok), and grafting (Jeophwajeok) characteristics, respectively. In response, Donghak Thought attempted to integrate the East and West by presenting the view of Heaven of the transcendent Heaven, the subsequent Gihwa (Materialization/Spiritualization) of the Earth, and an Innaechon (Man is Heaven) view of Humankind. The Cheon-oe-cheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) of Donghak, which first appeared in the approximately 4,600-year history of East Asian civilization tracing its origins from the Yellow Emperor, caused a great sensation in Joseon society at the time and developed into a large-scale peasant movement. However, Donghak Thought, which failed to overcome the limitations of Confucianism, instead remained a great Jakran (Creating Disorder) and Dongran (Causing Turmoil).

In response, Daesoon Thought, under the premise of the Incarnation of Gucheon (the Highest Heaven), introduced the concept of the divine beings of Heaven and Earth (Cheonji-sinmyeong) and revitalized the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind presented by Donghak Thought. Daesoon Thought reinterpreted Donghak Thought with the religious principles of Haewon-sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances for Mutual Beneficence) and Boeun-sangsaeng (Grateful Reciprocation of Favors for Mutual Beneficence), and built an indigenous modernity where Heaven, Earth, and divine beings (Sinmyeong) are combined Gihwaron (theory of materialization/spiritualization) through correlative thinking applicable even to everyday affairs.

In accordance with the principles of Daesoon Thought—Eumyang-hapdeok (Virtuous Concordance of Yin and Yang), Sin-in-johwa (Harmonious Union between Divine Beings and Human Beings), Haewon-sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances for Mutual Beneficence), and Dotong-jingyeong (Perfected State of Unification with the Dao)—Daesoon Thought presented the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind of indigenous modernity, such as the Samgye (Three Realms), Hucheon (Later World), Sangsaeng (Mutual Beneficence), Sindo (Dao of Divine Beings), Jiseon-cheonguk (Earthly Paradise), and Jiseon-sinseon (Earthly Immortals).

Based on the discussions above, the value and significance of this study are as follows. First, this study presented the indigenous modernity of the two thoughts as an alternative modernity to contemporary Western modernity, which is in crisis. The discourse on the indigenous modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought is a minority discourse today, but it is the only remaining discourse on modernity based on East Asian correlative thinking in the world. In the history of philosophy, there have been many cases where minority discourses transformed into mainstream discourses during times of crisis. Especially today, when humanity contemplates extinction due to the lack of an alternative modernity for the total crisis of modernity, such as the climate crisis and nuclear threats, the indigenous modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, as a discourse that integrates the strengths of ancient and modern, Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind through the liminality of correlative thinking, can present a practical alternative modernity in daily life.

Second, this dissertation presented the revitalization of correlative thinking as a solution for the stagnant growth of East Asian modernity. Over the past 150-plus years, East Asia, particularly the three countries of Korea, China, and Japan, which advocated the Sindo (Dao of Divine Beings) centering on Gucheon Sangje (Sangje of the Highest Heaven) and learned from Western modernity, has come to surpass the West economically. However, East Asia, finding nothing more to learn from the West, has now come to seek a new model for growth in its indigenous modernity. Accordingly, Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, which have uniquely built indigenous modernity based on correlative thinking among the three East Asian countries, present a model to recover the lost modernity in East Asia. This is applicable not only to communities but also to individuals in East Asia suffering from identity confusion, enabling them to overcome the comparative terrestrialism-based culture of Western modernity and establish new survival strategies with indigenous modernity.

Third, this dissertation can contribute to a comparative philosophical understanding of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought across all times and places. This study, which compares the indigenous modernity of the two thoughts with Western modernity focusing on the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humankind, facilitates an easier understanding of the inherent significance and value of the two thoughts. The characteristics of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought are more easily understood through comparison with existing Eastern and Western thoughts and contemporary scientific thought.